



Facebook user data struggle continues

Facebook gave user data to four Chinese companies, including Huawei, flagged as a security threat by US Intelligence. <https://digit.in/jul18-22-1>



World's first 7nm GPU

AMD revealed the world's first 7nm GPU with high-bandwidth memory of 32GB at Computex 2018. <https://digit.in/jul18-22-2>

Smart Home and Home automation: synonymous?

The terms 'smart home' and 'home automation' have been regularly been used interchangeably with each other. The jargon can get bewildering, so here's a stripped down version of the primary differences between the two seemingly-synonymous words.

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mart Homes and Home automation have transpired to becoming highly sought-after commodities

in today's technologically advanced era. Both terms are used by content creators and sellers as synonyms in most instances. But are they really one and the same?

HISTORY

The concept of a smart home was initially limited and came into fruition in the 70s with the inception of the X-10 home automation standard and devices that adhered to it. The invention of the internet circa 1900 was one of the major facilitators of these services. The real push towards this vision came with the inception of wireless networks or Wi-Fi around 1999. The Smart Home, as we know it today, was at its infancy between 1999 and 2007. The advances during those years allowed the combined ability of computing, remote access (on the internet)

and the creation of a wireless house network of few or many devices that possessed some form of intelligence.

The boom of 'domotics' or home automation came around when we witnessed the rise of complex electronic systems in the mid-80s that provided



The term smart home and home automation have often been used indistinctly.

the ability to automate. The concept received much acclaim and popularity but failed to reach the masses. Both installation and maintenance were priced exorbitantly. Technology would remain incapable of bringing this to fruition for the next two decades.

INTERNET OF THINGS OR IOT

The term IoT was first coined by Kevin Ashton way back in 1999 during a presentation he delivered at P&G. He noticed how an extension of the internet was being developed which accommodated 'Things' or objects trying to connect to it and therefore called it the Internet of Things.

Since then, IoT has evolved into a technology paradigm by itself and given the world a host of new devices to fit into their everyday interactions with technology. Our devices, like computers, tablets, laptops and smartphones were able to connect to household objects and devices. IoT, in many ways, was the enabler of home automation and smart homes.

HOME AUTOMATION

However technologically inept you might be, you are likely to be using at least one form of automation today. It may be anything from the timer on your toaster, coffee machine or microwave to the light that turns on in your